

Backup for certain obvious reasons. Titanium Backup is a one stop shop, and a complete solution for all your data backup needs. It allows you to upload backups to cloud services such as Dropbox, Google Drive and Box. The backup file is usually a single zip archive and can easily be restored using the app. You can also schedule automatic backups using this nifty tool. This is one of the best tools in case you want to transfer your data from one phone to another or, on the same phone, when you need to transfer data after formatting or installing a new ROM. This app is available in more than 30 languages, which makes it especially useful for people whose first language is not English.

Link: <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.keramidas.TitaniumBackup>

Tasker

Rated one of the best applications on the Google Play store, this app takes automation to a whole new level. The lead developer defines Tasker as an application for Android that performs tasks (sets of actions) based on contexts (application, time, date, location, event, gesture, etc) in user-defined profiles or in the widgets. This app allows you to run a series of tasks when a certain event is triggered. The Internet has several sites dedicated to Tasker profiles. Some popular ideas for Tasker profiles are:

- Creating an anti-theft application that allows GPS tracking; the app takes photos and emails information when a person tries to obtain unauthorised access
- Change your Internet settings (Wi-Fi to phone data and back) based on your current location
- Forward or block calls during meetings and at night
- Switch on or off user profiles based on your current location or time
- Start your favourite audio or video player automatically when headphones are connected
- Send scheduled SMSs based on dates
- Disable screen lock
- Change wallpaper based on the time of the day
- Create location-based reminders similar to Apple's Siri
- Create a one-click camera button/widget
- Put the phone on silent mode when it's placed facing down

These are only some of the widely used profiles. However, Tasker lets you do almost anything with your Android device, thus greatly improving your productivity as well as that of your device. In addition to Tasker, you should also install the Tasker App Factory extension. It is a clever add-on from the same developer. It allows you to create individual apps from tasks or projects. The best part is that you don't need any programming knowledge or even an Internet connection to create the apps. And once you have created an app, it can run on a standalone basis, i.e., it runs on a device without any intervention from Tasker or even without Tasker being present. This is a must-have companion for Android devices that have Tasker installed, especially devices running older versions of the Android platform.

Links: <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=net.dinglich.android.taskerm>

<https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=net.dinglich.android.appfactory>

GMD Gesture Control

This is an amazing app to introduce gestures to your Android device. Some gestures are provided by default. You are also allowed to create custom gestures and associate them with your favourite application or one of the events from the given list. There is also a launch bar that allows you to launch apps without much effort. In addition to these features, GMD Gesture Control also provides multi-tasking capabilities. You can launch applications without leaving the current application. Custom actions are also supported, whereby you can swipe between the previous and next applications, go Home or kill applications. There is also an option to hide the status bar so that you can enjoy your favourite applications on a full screen.

Link: <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.goodmooddroid.gesturecontrol>

AppLock

There are several reasons why you might want to protect certain applications from unauthorised use. It could be to shield your emails and chat applications from prying eyes or to provide an additional layer of protection for your bank and financial applications. In such cases, application lockers are a smart way to keep your private life safe and secure. There are some that actually work on non-rooted devices. One of the most widely used applications for this purpose is AppLock. A workaround against these application lockers on non-rooted devices is that a person can 'force close' an application and then open the app in question. To ensure maximum protection, we need to ensure that the application locker cannot be force closed. Protection against this is available in AppLock. Once installed and enabled, do not forget to enable the *Advanced Protection* mode from the AppLock settings, which is an add-on to AppLock. When you enable *Advanced Protection*, nobody can kill or uninstall AppLock without the password set by you. This combination gives a good deal of protection to the user and to the system apps.

Links: <https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.domobile.applock>

<https://play.google.com/store/apps/details?id=com.domobile.applockwatcher>

Root Explorer

There are several file managers available for the Android operating system. And quite a few of them allow you to navigate through and modify system files and folders. However, one file manager named Root Explorer stands out from the rest. As one of the most downloaded file managers, Root Explorer offers you terrific features such as multiple tab support, network (SMB) support, an SQLite database viewer, a nifty text editor, synchronisation with cloud services such as Google Drive